Steven Wilssens

Principal product leader: data, experimentation and AI

Seattle, Washington · US permanent resident (green card)
steven@wilssens.com · 425.533.7722
linkedin.com/in/steven-wilssens-59495889 · steven.wilssens.com

LOOKING FOR
Product leadership roles in data, experimentation and AI · available now

SCOPE
Led teams of 10 to 20 product managers; telemetry from 1.6B+ Windows devices

BACKGROUND
Product leader since 2008, software engineer and team lead before that

SUMMARY

Principal product leader with nearly 20 years at Microsoft building the data products, metrics, experimentation platforms and ML-powered insights that decide what ships across more than 1.6 billion Windows devices. I led teams of 10 to 20 product managers, turned telemetry and customer signals into decision systems used by engineers and product leaders, and kept building myself, most recently in AI.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

250%+
growth in monthly active spatial-audio devices

1.6B+
Windows devices informing product decisions

15%
increase in Windows adoption

30%
reduction in customer issues

SKILLS

Product strategy and roadmaps · Data platforms and telemetry · Experimentation and A/B testing · Machine learning and AI products · Metrics and decision systems · Leading PM teams (10 to 20 PMs) · Stakeholder and executive communication · Go-to-market and partnerships · Software engineering background (C#, .NET)

EXPERIENCE

Oct 2026 - Present

Independent AI Product Builder

Independent · Seattle, Washington

Building AI products independently after Microsoft.

- Building AI Breaker, a Windows app that lets people turn off AI features in graduated levels.
- Built wilssens.com, a family platform with sites, email and AI apps over MCP, in 16 days.
- Runs juniortrackcycling.com, a content and analytics site for the junior track cycling community.

Dec 2024 - Sep 2026

Principal Group Product Manager - Windows & Devices Data

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Led product management for the entire Windows & Devices Data organization: the data, insights, experimentation, and machine learning models that power decision-making across Windows and Devices.

- Led a PM organization of 10 to 20, initially through three people managers, and designed its move to a flatter structure; roughly half the team was promoted under my leadership.
- Owned strategy and roadmap for the data platform and insights products Windows engineers and PMs use to ship higher-quality releases.
- Built the quality measurement framework that underpinned Windows K2, Microsoft's high-profile push to improve Windows reliability and performance.
- Ran the weekly ship-readiness quality review where Windows VPs made release decisions based on my team's data on ship-blocking issues.
- Scaled experimentation adoption across Windows, significantly reducing the number of features pulled back after release.
- Owned the multi-million-dollar Windows data infrastructure budget; shut down a low-adoption on-device model platform and reinvested in platform modernization, cutting costs 30% over two years.
- Shifted the team to AI-driven analytics and launched the first version, letting people ask business questions in natural language across every source in the data platform instead of relying on fixed queries.
- Partnered with engineering, data science, and research leadership across telemetry from more than 1.6 billion Windows devices.

Feb 2020 - Dec 2024

Principal Product Manager Lead - Windows Data

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Built data products that told the story of the Windows customer experience and informed continuous improvement.

- Redefined Windows quality measurement around end-to-end scenarios like gaming and the shell, creating the Perfect Day metric for issue-free user days.

Sep 2019 - Feb 2020

Principal Product Manager Lead - Azure DevOps

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Defined new products, go-to-market strategies, and business decisions for the Azure DevOps Platform.

- Authored a DataOps product proposal compelling enough that the team building it was moved to GitHub, as the better home for the product.

Jan 2018 - Sep 2019

Principal Product Manager Lead - Silicon, Graphics, Media

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Led audio, spatial audio, game streaming, xCloud, Game DVR, broadcast, and casting initiatives.

- Led the Microsoft Spatial Audio Platform across Windows, Xbox One, and new platforms.

Sep 2017 - Jan 2018

Principal Product Manager - Silicon, Graphics, Media

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Drove the Windows Sonic spatial audio platform for Windows and Xbox One while representing Microsoft at developer and game conferences.

- Drove the launch of Dolby Access v3 and DTS Sound Unbound with new app services, licensing, and customization models.

Oct 2008 - Aug 2017

Senior Product Manager - Silicon, Graphics, Media

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Developed the Spatial Audio Platform, including Windows Sonic, for Windows and Xbox One.

- Brought spatial sound to Windows and Xbox: Windows Sonic for headphones, plus Dolby Atmos and DTS:X across headphones, home theater, and built-in laptop speakers on Surface, Lenovo and other devices.
- Co-inventor on 17 granted US patents in spatial audio, game streaming, and adaptive audio rendering.

Oct 2006 - Sep 2008

Product Manager - Developer Division

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Product manager in Microsoft's Developer Division working on developer ecosystem and community products.

- Launched the Visual Studio Marketplace, giving developers one place to find and share Visual Studio extensions.
- Drove CodePlex, Microsoft's open-source project hosting site.

EARLIER CAREER · BELGIUM

Jan 2006 - Sep 2006

Lead Developer and Team Lead, Compuware · Belgium
Led a team of about 15 developers and the Project Support Office for Fluxys.

Jan 2004 - Dec 2005

Software Developer, Cosmos · Antwerp Area, Belgium
Built and supported software components across C# client and Java server systems using CORBA middleware.

Jan 2001 - Dec 2004

Developer and Trainer, Info Support · Belgium
Developed distributed .NET applications and trained teams across multiple organizations.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's degree, Computer Science
Karel de Grote, Belgium · 2000 - 2004

Languages
Dutch and English (native), French (intermediate)

HONORS

- Microsoft Lighthouse Award for Teamwork · Jan 2012
- Microsoft Compass Award for Individual Excellence · Jan 2011
- Microsoft Gold Star Award · Jan 2011
- Most Valuable Professional (MVP): VS Team System · Jan 2006

PATENTS AND PRESS

19 granted US patents, 7 published applications
Spatial audio, streaming, media and device telemetry, assigned to Microsoft. Press in Forbes and Windows Central on the spatial audio work; Build 2016 speaker. Full list: steven.wilssens.com/patents